From what we have learned from our consulting clients, organizations that implement automated deployments have a higher chance of success in the cloud.

In this chapter, you will learn how to automate the deployment of an application. We want to introduce three approaches with different pros and cons, so that you can pick the solution that best fits your situation. We use the following three options and will provide an overview that helps you make a decision at the end of the chapter:

- AWS CodeDeploy to deploy to running EC2 instances
- AWS CloudFormation, Auto Scaling groups, and user data to perform a rolling update
- Bundling an application into a customized AMI for immutable deployments with Packer by HashiCorp

Examples are 100% covered by the Free Tier

The examples in this chapter are completely covered by the Free Tier. As long as you don't run the examples longer than a few days, you won't pay anything. Keep in mind that this only applies if you created a fresh AWS account for this book and nothing else is going on in your AWS account. Try to complete each section within a few days; you'll clean up your account at the end of each section.

Chapter requirements